TOOLKIT

NIGCOMSAT Fact Sheet

Verified facts for real examples, with sources.

Real facts to use in examples, so every Naija story in this course stands on solid ground. Each fact has a source. **The course datasets are synthetic**: built to behave like this satellite, but not real NIGCOMSAT records.

The company

Fact	Detail	Source
Name	Nigerian Communications Satellite Limited (NIGCOMSAT)	SpaceHubs Africa
Role	Government-owned satellite operator under the federal ministry responsible for communications and the digital economy	SpaceHubs Africa
Leadership	Managing Director/CEO **Jane Nkechi Egerton-Idehen** (appointed 2023)	TechEconomy, Techmoonshot
Broadcast	Carries **over 50% of Nigeria's broadcast traffic**, including digital switch-over (DSO) traffic for the NBC	Nairametrics
Clients named in the press	NBC, Galaxy Backbone, NIMC	Nairametrics
Revenue	About ₦2 billion in 2025, up from about ₦650 million the year before	Nairametrics

NigComSat-1R: the satellite in our data

Fact	Detail	Source
Orbit	Geostationary, at **42.5° East**	NIGCOMSAT fleet page, SatBeams
Launch	December 2011, on a Chinese Long March rocket	Space.com, CGWIC
Platform	DFH-4, built by the China Academy of Space Technology	CGWIC
Design life	**15 years**	CGWIC, NIGCOMSAT
Transponders	**28 active**: 4 C-band, 14 Ku-band, 8 Ka-band, 2 L-band (navigation)	NASRDA, CGWIC
Ka-band	8 channels of 120 MHz; spot beams over **Nigeria**, South Africa and Europe	NASRDA

Fact	Detail	Source
L-band	Navigation payload (L1, L5) supporting satellite-based augmentation for Africa and the Indian Ocean	EnviroNews
Services	Broadcasting (incl. direct-to-home TV), broadband, enterprise and government connectivity	Space in Africa

History and what's next

Fact	Detail	Source
NigComSat-1	Launched 2007; **failed in November 2008 after a solar-array anomaly left it without power**	Wikipedia
The gap	Roughly four years without a satellite, and several clients left	Nairametrics
Replacements	**NIGCOMSAT-2A and 2B**, high-throughput satellites, approved by the Federal Executive Council; built by Thales Alenia Space and Israel Aerospace Industries	Techmoonshot
Launch targets	2A targeted for 2028, 2B for 2029 (agency targets: earlier plans slipped)	Techmoonshot

Nigerian context used in the course

Fact	Detail	Source
Time zone	West Africa Time, **UTC + 1** all year, no daylight saving	–
Rainy season	Roughly April to October, earlier and longer in the south, shorter in the far north; NiMet publishes onset and end dates each year	Guardian (NiMet outlook)
Regions	Six geopolitical zones: North West, North East, North Central, South West, South East, South South (used in `vsat_uptime_by_region_weekly`)	–

Which fact powers which day

Day	Fact	Why it lands
W1D1	42.5°E, 28 transponders, 15-year life	Meet the star of the course
W1D2	Ka-band + rainy season	Rain fade is the "DStv in heavy rain" story
W3D1	NigComSat-1 lost to a **solar-array failure**	Why we watch solar-array current so closely

Day	Fact	Why it lands
W6D2	15-year design life from 2011, replacements targeted for 2028/2029	Remaining useful life is a real national question
Final project	50% of broadcast traffic, government clients	Why reliable monitoring matters